Corporate Finance

Lecture 2 extras: Read the news, and look around you

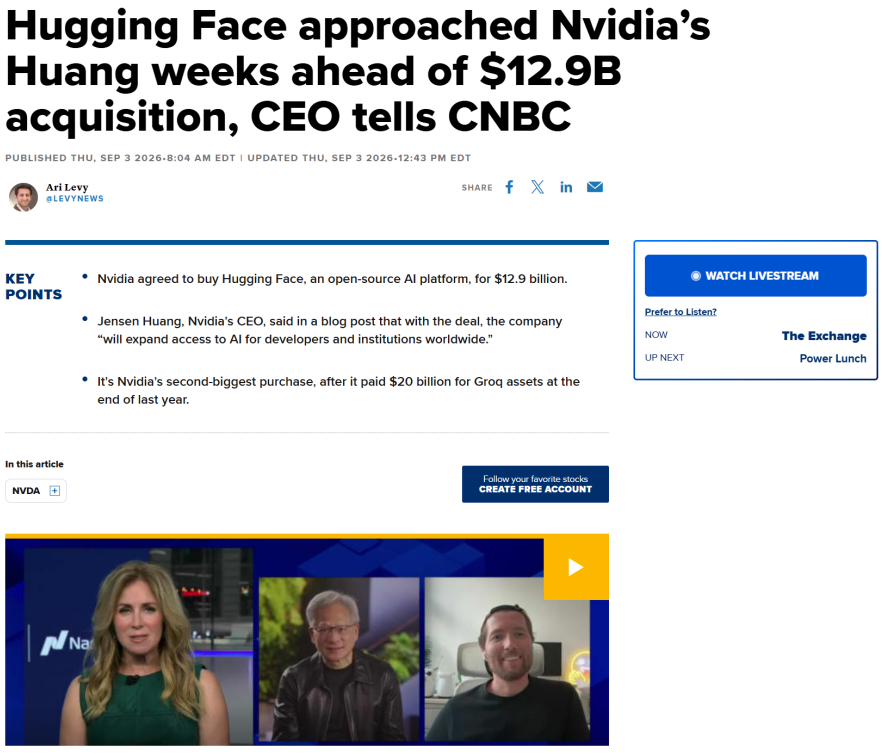
Camilo Saldarriaga

Finance Department, ESCP Business School, 2026/2027

Read the Financial Times, for free

- ESCP gives every student **free access to FT.com** through your ESCP email.
- To set it up: go to ft.com, click on any article, and fill in the form with your **ESCP email address**. The FT recognises the domain and activates the subscription. Then download the FT app.
- Why bother? Everything we do in this course is happening right now: interest rates, IPOs, takeovers, dividend cuts, market crashes. Reading the FT for 15 minutes a day is the fastest way to make the theory concrete.
- Tip: add topics to *myFT* (Markets, Private equity, Tech).

Nvidia buys Hugging Face for USD 12.9 billion



Hugging Face approached Nvidia's Huang weeks ahead of $12.9B acquisition, CEO tells CNBC

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KEY POINTS

- Nvidia agreed to buy Hugging Face, an open-source AI platform, for $12.9 billion.
- Jensen Huang, Nvidia's CEO, said in a blog post that with the deal, the company "will expand access to AI for developers and institutions worldwide."
- It's Nvidia's second-biggest purchase, after it paid $20 billion for Groq assets at the end of last year.

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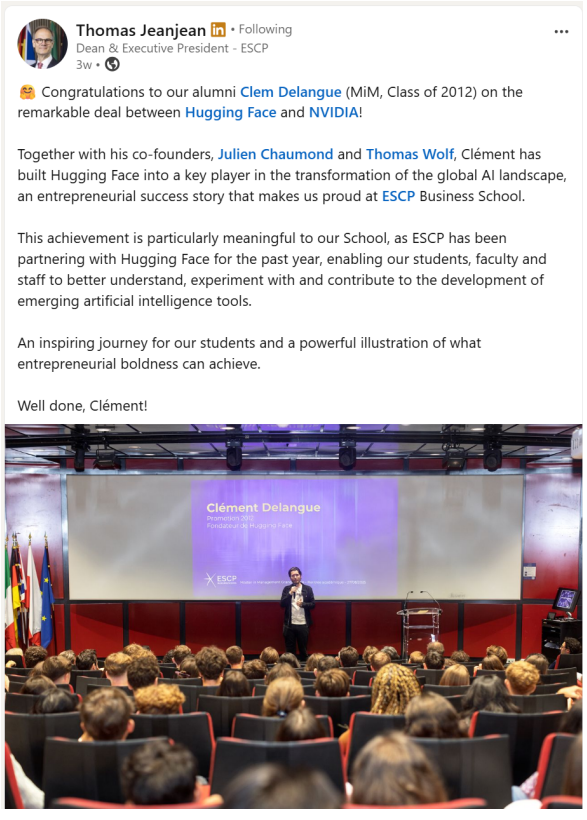
NVDA

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- Hugging Face: the open-source platform where most AI models are shared. Founded in 2016 by three French entrepreneurs.
- 3 September 2026: Nvidia buys it for **USD 12.9 billion**, its second-largest acquisition ever.
- It started as a chatbot app for teenagers. This is what an AI ecosystem looks like when it works.

Source: CNBC, 3 September 2026.

One of the founders sat where you sit

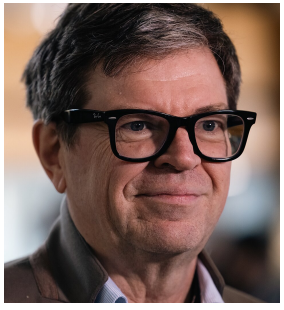


- Clément Delangue, CEO and co-founder of Hugging Face: ESCP **Master in Management, Class of 2012**. Same programme, same campus.
- ESCP has partnered with Hugging Face for the past year, so you can experiment with the tools directly.
- Paris is one of the busiest places in the world for AI entrepreneurship, and ESCP is in the middle of it. This story did not need a PhD in mathematics: a good idea, ambition, and the finance to fund it.

Source: LinkedIn post by Thomas Jeanjean, Dean of ESCP, September 2026.

ESCP School of Technology, opening 2027





Yann Le Cun

- A new **School of Technology** in 2027, under the patronage of **Yann Le Cun**, one of the founding figures of modern AI.
- First programme: a Bachelor in Management, Science & Technology. English, Paris then Turin then London, 40 students in the first intake.
- Then three MSc: robotics & logistics, product management, technology for managers.
- Part of the "Bold & United" 2026-2030 plan: a School of Governance follows in 2029.

Source: Capital.fr, 11 June 2026. Photo: Wikimedia Commons, CC BY-SA 2.0.